

Admin guide

Admins can do everything a manager can, plus manage **users**, **services**, the **sidebar (Menu Controller)**, the **audit log**, and **backups**.

Admins must use **Two-Factor Authentication** — see [Getting Started](#).

1. Users — add and manage staff

Public sign-up is disabled, so **you create every staff account**.

- **Users** → **Add user** → name, email, **role**, and a temporary password.

Leave **Active** ticked.

- Give the person their email + temporary password; they change it on first login. Admins/managers will be guided through 2FA setup.

- **Edit** a user to change their name, email, role, or reset their password.
- **When someone leaves:** edit them and **untick Active** instead of deleting —

this blocks their login but keeps their leads, deals and history intact.

- You **can't** disable, demote, or delete **your own** account (so you can't lock yourself out).

Additional roles (someone doing two jobs): every user has one ****primary role (the dropdown above) plus an optional set of additional roles**** — checkboxes further down the same Add/Edit form. Additional roles:

- **Do** expand what the person can directly do (Policies), who they show up for in role-targeted notifications (Deal Won, SLA breach, leave-request approvals, recurring-invoice due warnings, etc.), and owner-picker dropdowns (Client/Lead "assign to").

- **Do not** change their sidebar or their dashboard panel — those always follow the primary role only. If someone needs the extra sidebar items their additional role would normally show, grant them individually via

Menu Controller → **per-user overrides**.

- **Do not** affect auto-assignment/routing (new-lead auto-owner, automatic task routing to a project's Support assignee) — those also stay primary-role-only, by design.

Roles available:

Role	What they can access
Admin	Everything, including users, menu controller, audit log, backups
Manager	All modules except user/menu/audit/backup admin
Sales	Leads, deals, their own clients, quotations, projects, tasks, tickets, calls
Support	Tickets, projects (assigned), clients (read-only), calls, tasks
Accounts	Invoices, payments, clients, recurring invoices
Intern	Clients (read-only), Projects (assigned), Tasks (assigned), Attendance, Daily Reports

Biometric Device User ID: each user record has an optional

Biometric Device User ID field. Set this to the numeric ID from the eSSL attendance machine's Device Users list. Once set, punches from that person on the biometric machine automatically update their CRM attendance record (check-in and check-out times). See Section 1a below.

1a. Biometric attendance sync (eSSL machine)

The CRM is connected to the **eSSL x 2008** biometric attendance machine (serial NFZ8243301103). When staff punch in or out on the machine, their attendance is automatically synced to the CRM — no manual check-in needed.

How it works:

- The machine sends each punch to the CRM automatically via the internet.
- The **first punch of the day** sets the check-in time.
- The **last punch of the day** sets the check-out time.
- If a staff member also pressed the manual check-in button on the CRM

dashboard, the biometric punch will update the record with the exact time from the machine.

To map a staff member to the machine:

1. On the machine, go to **Menu** → **User Mgt** to find the person's numeric User ID (e.g. 1, 3, 13, 16 ...).

1. In the CRM, go to **Users** → **Edit** the staff member.
2. Enter that number in the **Biometric Device User ID** field and save.

From that point on, the machine's punches update their attendance automatically.

If the sync stops working, check that `BIOMETRIC_DEVICE_SERIAL` is set correctly in the server `.env` and run `php artisan config:cache`. The machine's Cloud Server settings should point to `crm.talktonitesh.com` on port 443 with HTTPS on.

Occasional missing punches: the biometric machine's own stored log can get trimmed during the day by other software that also reads it (the "hitech" billing software), so a punch can occasionally never reach the CRM at all. If someone's check-in or check-out looks wrong or missing on the Attendance page:

1. In **hitech**, open that staff member's **Attendance** tab, pick the

date range, and click **Export To Excel**.

1. In the CRM, go to **Attendance** → **Import from Hitech**, pick the staff member, and upload that file.

1. Review the preview (it shows Hitech's times next to what the CRM currently has) and click **Import**. Only the fields Hitech actually reports are written — it never erases a value the CRM already has just because a cell is blank (e.g. someone who hasn't clocked out yet when the export was taken).

2. Services — the service-line taxonomy

Services lists your offerings (SEO, GMB, Website Design & Development, Social Media, Performance Marketing, Software Development, AI Automation, AMC Service). These power every report's service breakdown.

- **Add** a new service line, **rename**, set the **sort order**, or ****toggle active****.
- A service **in use** by leads/deals/projects/tickets can't be deleted — just deactivate it so it stays on old records but isn't offered for new ones.

2a. Festivals — the greeting calendar

Festivals drives two things: a "🎨 Diwali is in 5 days!" banner everyone sees on their dashboard, and AI-drafted client greeting content (see below).

Fixed-date national holidays are always pre-loaded (Independence Day, Gandhi Jayanti, Christmas, New Year's Day, Republic Day, Maharashtra Day).

****Lunar/regional festivals shift every year and are NOT pre-loaded by default.**** As of 2026-07-05, the remaining lunar/regional festivals of 2026 were verified against multiple calendar sources and added: Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi (26 Aug — moon-sighting dependent, confirm closer to the date), Raksha Bandhan (28 Aug — one source disagreed with 9 Aug, double-check a regional panchang), Janmashtami (4 Sep), Ganesh Chaturthi (14 Sep), Navratri/Ghatasthapana (11 Oct), Dussehra (20 Oct), and Diwali/Lakshmi Puja (8 Nov). Sources:

drikpanchang.com,
timeanddate.com.

These dates do not carry forward to next year — every January, re-verify and re-add that year's lunar/regional festivals from an official calendar; don't assume last year's dates still apply. Add a festival with a name and date; toggle **Active** to hide one without deleting it (e.g. after the year it applies to has passed).

AI-drafted client greetings: every morning, the CRM checks for festivals 7 days out and — for every active client with a **Social Media** or **GMB** project — automatically drafts a short greeting caption with Claude and adds it to that project's Content Collaboration queue (tagged with a 🎨 badge).

Nothing is ever posted automatically — a team member always reviews, edits, and approves it like any other content piece. Requires `AI_ENABLED` (see Section 12).

2b. Client Radar — at-risk / upsell signals

A dashboard banner ("N clients need attention") and a **Client Radar** sidebar page (Admin/Manager only) flag active clients worth a proactive check-in:

- **No Contact** — no note, call log, or ticket in the last 14 days.
- **Declining Activity** — touches in the last 30 days are well below the 30 days before that (only shown when No Contact doesn't already apply).
- **Overdue Invoice** — the client has at least one overdue invoice.
- **Growth Opportunity** — the client only uses one of the agency's service lines, even though more are active — a natural upsell conversation starter.

Everything on this page is computed live from existing CRM data — nothing is stored or sent automatically. Click 🌟 **Suggest action** next to a flagged client to have Claude draft a short, specific next step (a check-in call, a service to pitch, tactfully chasing payment) based only on that client's flags. This is generated on demand, one client at a time — not run as a batch job — so there's no AI cost unless someone actually looks at a client.

3. Menu Controller — who sees what

The **Menu Controller** has two parts:

- **Role grid** — which roles can reach each module. *This controls real access.*
- **Per-user overrides** — show/hide individual sidebar items for one person.

Cosmetic only — it tidies someone's sidebar but does **not** grant or remove permission (that's always governed by roles). A banner on the page reminds you of this.

Changes apply on the user's next page load.

4. Clients — status, bulk import & deletion

Client status: clients have three statuses:

- **Prospect** (yellow) — created when a lead is converted. Not yet a paying client.
- **Active** (green) — promoted automatically when their deal is marked **Won**.
- **Inactive** — set manually when a relationship ends.

The Clients list defaults to showing Active clients. Use the status filter to view Prospects, Inactive, or all. You can also set the status manually on the client's edit page.

Import (Clients → Import): upload a CSV. The template (downloadable from the import page) has 13 columns including `address_line2`, `owner` (user's full name), and `tags` (comma-separated). Leave `owner` blank to assign the client to the importing user. Duplicate emails and GSTINs (including soft-deleted records) are

skipped automatically.

Deleting a client: removes the client **and all related records** — deals, quotations, invoices, projects, tasks, tickets, contacts, notes, and call logs.

This cannot be undone. Use this only when the company record should be wiped entirely; consider making a client **Inactive** instead if you may need the history later.

5. WhatsApp integration

The CRM is connected to **wadesk.in** (your WhatsApp dashboard). When a client messages your WhatsApp support number with a **new conversation** (or reopens a resolved one), a support ticket is automatically created in the CRM.

- The ticket appears with a green **WhatsApp** badge on the Tickets list.
- If the client's phone number matches an existing client record, a **ticket**

is created and linked to them. If no match is found, a **lead** is created instead (source WhatsApp) — check **Lead Generation**, not Tickets, for enquiries from numbers that aren't clients yet.

- Each conversation creates **one ticket** (or one lead) — subsequent messages in the same conversation don't create duplicates; for a lead, later messages are added as notes on it instead.

- Staff reply to the client from **wadesk.in** directly. Replies can also be logged as ticket notes in the CRM to keep the record complete.

This integration is configured via `COMPANY_WHATSAPP` and `WHATSAPP_WEBHOOK_TOKEN` in the server `.env`. Contact your developer if the integration stops creating tickets.

6. Scheduled maintenance tasks

The CRM runs `app:dispatch-scheduled-tasks` at **8 AM IST daily** via the cron scheduler. It scans every active project, matches it to a set of built-in task templates by service, and creates tasks due today — assigned to the project lead with an in-app bell notification.

No configuration is needed — templates are built into the command and cover all NEDS service lines (Website Dev, SEO, GMB, Social Media, Performance Marketing, Software Development, AI Automation, AMC Service). Each doc section of Kiran's service-task checklist (Technical SEO, On-Page SEO, GMB Profile & Engagement, etc.) became one consolidated recurring task with the full checklist in its description — not one task per line item — so the list stays manageable even with dozens of active projects.

Backfill a missed date (e.g. server was down, or a project was just made active):

```
```bash
php artisan app:dispatch-scheduled-tasks --date=2026-07-01
```
```

The command is idempotent — running it twice for the same date will not create duplicate tasks.

Verify it ran: open any active project in Emptask and check that tasks were created today. Or check the server cron log.

New project onboarding checklist: when a project is created (manually, or automatically from a won deal) and its status is Active, the CRM also one-time-creates a matching onboarding checklist for its service (e.g. SEO gets "Technical SEO setup", "On-page SEO setup", "Off-page SEO setup", and "Initial SEO report", each due a few days to a few weeks out) — assigned to the project lead (or the project manager if no lead is set yet). This only fires once per project, not on a schedule.

How staff see these: on the Daily Reports page, **My Tasks** groups tasks by project and collapses these auto-created tasks under a "🔧 routine maintenance" line (tasks a person assigned directly stay expanded above it). The distinction is automatic — any task with no creator recorded is treated as routine maintenance — so nothing needs to be tagged manually.

How Admin/Manager see these on Emptask: the company-wide **Emptask** list defaults to a **"Assigned tasks"** filter, hiding routine maintenance tasks so 267+ auto-created checks don't bury the handful of tasks someone actually needs to review. Switch the filter dropdown to **"Routine maintenance"** to audit just those, or **"All tasks"** to see everything — routine tasks are marked with a 🔧 icon wherever they appear mixed in.

Team workload summary: above the filter bar, Emptask shows a one-row-per-person table — total tasks, a To Do / In Progress / Review / Done breakdown, and an overdue count (highlighted in red) — combining assigned and routine tasks so it reflects everyone's real workload, even though routine tasks are hidden from the detailed list by default. Click a name to jump straight to that person's full task list.

7. NEDS tool integrations (Drishti & SMDost)

The CRM is connected to **nedsdrishti.in** and **socialmediadost.com**. Seven automated workflows run between the three tools. The full details are in the [Integrations guide](#). In summary:

| When this happens in CRM | This happens automatically |
|--|---|
| Deal marked Won | Client + user created in Drishti and SMDost |
| Brief fully approved in SMDost | Draft invoice created in CRM; accounts notified |
| Content piece marked Send to agency in SMDost | *NEDS-led* content piece auto-created in CRM project (status: *Sent to partner*), pre-filled with copy text |
| Drishti post approved/published | Activity logged on the client's CRM timeline |
| 1st of the month (7:30 AM) | Monthly content briefs auto-created in SMDost |
| Client opens portal SSO button | One-click login to Drishti or SMDost |
| WhatsApp ticket opened | Drishti context link auto-appended to ticket |

Keeping integrations healthy: all events leave a trace in the client's Activity feed. If an integration stops working, the most common fix is verifying the server `.env` keys (`DRISHTI_SERVICE_KEY` , `SMDOST_SERVICE_KEY` , `PORTAL_SSO_SECRET`) and running `php artisan config:cache` . See the [Integrations guide](#) for step-by-step troubleshooting.

8. Lead capture channels

Leads flow into the CRM automatically from three channels — no manual entry needed for any of them:

- **Website** — the niranjanenterprises.com contact form creates a lead on every submission. The message the visitor typed appears in the lead's **Notes** tab; service and company fields are captured when filled in. If the form was built with hidden UTM fields, the lead's **Campaign** line shows which ad/link it came from (see the Lead Source Performance report in the manager guide). Configured via `LEAD_CAPTURE_TOKEN` in `.env` — if the form stops creating leads, check it matches the Elementor webhook URL.
- **WhatsApp** — a message from a number that isn't an existing client's creates a lead (source WhatsApp) instead of a ticket — see Section 5.
- **Meta Lead Ads** (Facebook/Instagram) — a lead form submission on a Meta ad creates a lead (source Meta Ads) via a webhook. Requires a Facebook Developer App, a registered webhook subscription, and a Page access token — **not configured yet**; see below to set it up.

All new leads auto-assign to whichever active Sales user currently has the fewest open leads, so nothing sits unowned waiting for someone to notice it (this runs regardless of whether AI is enabled — see the AI features section for the AI-specific parts: scoring, hot-lead alerts, nurture follow-ups).

Setting up Meta Lead Ads (once you have a Facebook Developer App and Page for the ad account):

1. In the Meta App Dashboard, add the **Webhooks** product, subscribe to the

Page object's `leadgen` field.

1. Callback URL: `https://crm.talktonitesh.com/api/webhooks/meta-leads` .

Verify token: any value you choose — set the same value in both Meta's dashboard and the server's `META_WEBHOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN` .

1. Set `META_APP_SECRET` (from the app's Basic Settings) and `META_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN` (a Page access token with `leads_retrieval` permission) in the server `.env` , then `php artisan config:cache` .

1. Submit a test lead on the ad form and confirm it appears in ****Lead Generation with source Meta Ads****.

9. Partners — content agency directory

Partners in the sidebar is a directory of the external content agencies NEDS collaborates with. Managers and admins can add, edit, and delete partner records.

Each partner needs only a **name**. Email and phone are optional but useful for quick reference when you need to contact the agency.

Once a partner is registered, staff can assign them to content pieces inside projects (see [Manager guide](#) → [Content collaboration](#)).

Deleting a partner is allowed only when no content pieces are linked to them — the CRM will block the delete and show an error if any pieces still reference that partner.

10. Audit Log

Audit Log (admin) shows who created, updated or deleted records, and when.

Filter by record type or event. Use it to investigate "who changed this?".

11. Backups

The database is **backed up automatically every night at 2 AM** (kept 14 daily + 8 weekly copies on the server). You don't need to do anything. To restore from a backup, follow `docs/backup-restore.md` .

12. AI features (optional)

Nine AI helpers are built into the CRM, powered by Anthropic's Claude. They are **off by default** and never take action, send, publish, or score an employee automatically — they only draft or summarize for a human to review.

Lead scoring — when a lead is created or edited, the CRM automatically sends its details to Claude and stores a **0–100 score** with a one-line reason (e.g. "Specific service requested, phone and company provided — high intent"), plus an estimated **budget band**, **urgency**, and **service fit** note. The score badge appears on the leads list so sales staff can prioritise without reading every entry. Existing leads (created before AI was enabled) get scored

the next time they are edited and saved. A lead scoring **70 or above** is flagged 🔥 Hot and its owner gets an immediate bell notification instead of waiting for the next morning digest — configurable via `AI_HOT_LEAD_THRESHOLD` in `.env` (default 70).

Lead auto-assignment — a new lead with no owner (e.g. from the website form) is automatically assigned to whichever active Sales user currently owns the fewest open leads, so leads never sit unowned. This runs independently of `AI_ENABLED` — it's routing, not an AI feature.

Draft follow-up / Draft reply (👉) — a button on leads and tickets. When clicked, Claude reads the lead/ticket details and history, then writes a suggested message. The staff member edits it and sends it themselves. Claude never sends anything automatically.

Automated lead nurture follow-ups — daily at 10:30 IST, any New lead its owner hasn't personally added a note or logged a call on gets an AI-drafted follow-up at day 1 (first outreach), day 3 (gentle nudge), and day 7 (final, low-pressure check-in) since it came in. Each draft lands as a staff-only note on the lead plus a bell notification to the owner — never sent automatically. The system-generated note created from the original enquiry (website form / WhatsApp message) doesn't count as a staff touch, so a lead that's never actually been worked still qualifies. Skips Sundays, same as the stagnation alerts.

Summarize — a button on client pages and tickets. Claude reads the full timeline (notes, calls, interactions) and produces a short paragraph summarising the situation. Useful when picking up a colleague's account.

Festival greeting drafts — every morning, for clients with an active Social Media or GMB project, Claude drafts a festival greeting caption 7 days ahead of each entry in the **Festivals** calendar (Section 2a) and adds it to that project's Content Collaboration queue as a draft. A team member always reviews and approves it before anything is scheduled or published.

AI daily-priorities digest — every staff member with anything due gets a short AI-written "here's your day" line at the top of their 9 AM morning digest email, which also appears as a dashboard banner for the rest of that day. It's generated only from that person's own tasks/follow-ups.

Team performance summary (👉 Generate AI Summary) — a button on the **Employee Performance Report** (Reports panel) that turns the existing tasks/calls/attendance numbers into a narrative of trends and standouts.

Visible to Admin/Manager only — it is never shown to the employee it's about, so it's a starting point for a conversation, not a rating you share.

Client Radar suggestions (👉 Suggest action) — on the **Client Radar** page (Section 2b), a button per flagged client that has Claude suggest one concrete next action based on that client's specific signals. Generated on demand per

client, not in a batch — so it costs nothing unless someone clicks it.

Monthly wins note drafts — on the 1st of each month, for every active client with an assigned owner who had at least one task completed, ticket resolved, payment received, or (for clients Drishti manages) a post published, audit completed, or marketing action item done the month before, Claude drafts a short "here's what we delivered" note and adds it to that client's Notes tab (staff-only, marked "AI-drafted monthly update"). The owner gets a bell notification. Nothing is sent to the client automatically — the account manager reviews, personalizes, and sends it themselves. Clients with nothing to report that month are skipped entirely (no hollow note, no AI call spent). The Drishti numbers are pulled live via a service-to-service call — if Drishti is unreachable that day, the note still drafts from whatever the CRM itself knows (tasks/tickets/payments).

Project daily update drafts — every evening at 6:30 PM (skipped on Sundays), for each active project with at least one task completed that day, Claude drafts a short client-facing progress update from the completed task titles and stores it as a pending note (`ai_generated = true` , `visible_to_client = false`) — not yet visible anywhere the client can see it.

The project owner gets a bell notification and, on the project's page, a

Pending Client Update panel to edit and either **Approve & Send** (flips the note to `visible_to_client = true` , which is what makes it appear in the client portal feed, and emails the client's billing contact) or **Discard**.

Admin/Manager can also approve or discard on any project, not just their own.

This differs from the monthly wins note above in one important way: that one is staff-only forever, meant to be copied and sent manually; this one has a real send step built in, and is what actually reaches the client once approved. Projects with no activity that day are skipped silently — no hollow draft, no AI call spent, no notification.

Project Updates Digest (leadership oversight) — every morning at 9:15 AM (skipped on Sundays), every active Admin/Manager gets one email covering the whole project daily-update workflow across the team, not just their own projects:

- **Yesterday's client updates** — how many were drafted, how many got approved & sent, how many are still awaiting review.
- **Client updates awaiting review 2+ days** — a table of drafts nobody has approved or discarded yet, with the project, its Project Manager, and how long it's been waiting. Keeps surfacing every day until someone acts on it.
- **Projects gone quiet 5+ days** — active projects with no completed task and no note (of any kind) in the last 5 days, so a project that's stalled doesn't go unnoticed just because nobody happened to look at it. New projects get a grace period before they can be flagged this way.

Nothing is sent if there's genuinely nothing to report that day — no filler email. Both thresholds (`--stale-days` , default 2; `--quiet-days` , default 5) are command options if they ever need adjusting.

To turn on: add these two lines to the server `.env` , then run

```
php artisan config:cache :
```

```
...
```

```
AI_ENABLED=true
```

```
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-...
```

```
...
```

If the features are off, the buttons/drafts/digests simply don't appear and nothing else changes. Usage is billed by Anthropic per request (very low cost for this volume).

Tip

Adding a new module/menu item or changing a label is a code change that deploys automatically — but the menu lives in the database, so after such a change the menu must be re-seeded on the server (``php artisan db:seed --class=MenuItemsSeeder --force``).